

Call Prep: Concentrate AI Demo & Reconnect

Date: Tuesday, June 30, 2026 | 10:30–11:00 AM CT | Microsoft Teams

Attendee: Ari Jacoby, CEO & Co-Founder, Concentrate AI (ari@concentrate.ai)

Format: 30-minute demo and reconnect

1. Background / History

Ari Jacoby is a seasoned serial entrepreneur with a consistent pattern of founding, scaling, and exiting B2B technology companies. He co-founded and led:

- **Voicestar** — acquired by Marchex (call analytics)
- **Solve Media** — acquired by Adiant (CAPTCHA/fraud mitigation; Ticketmaster was an early customer)
- **Circulate** — acquired by LiveRamp/Axiom (identity data)
- **Newsletters.com** — acquired by MarketResearch
- **Deduce** — identity fraud prevention platform powered by a network of 150,000+ partner websites; this was his most recent prior company before founding Concentrate AI

He holds a BA in Government and Economics from Georgetown University. His background is not purely technical — he's a product-and-go-to-market founder who identifies friction in enterprise workflows and builds infrastructure businesses around solving it. His infosec thread runs from early CAPTCHA/fraud work through Deduce; Concentrate AI extends that into AI governance and spend control.

Concentrate AI was co-founded with **Todd Lieberman** in 2025 and launched publicly in June 2026. No prior relationship or notes on Ari or Concentrate AI exist in the Obsidian vault — this appears to be a new relationship for Improving.

2. Company Overview

Concentrate AI is a New York City-based AI infrastructure startup founded in 2025 and publicly launched in June 2026. It raised a **\$5M pre-seed round** from **True Ventures** and **RRE Ventures**.

What they build: An enterprise LLM gateway — a managed operating layer that gives organizations unified API access to every major model (OpenAI, Anthropic, Google, xAI, and others) through a single endpoint. Think of it as the API management and governance plane for AI model usage.

Core product capabilities:

- Multi-model routing: intelligently distributes workloads across providers to optimize cost, latency, and uptime
- Automatic failover between providers during outages or performance degradation
- Enterprise security stack included by default: SSO, RBAC, audit logging, sensitive-data guardrails, zero data retention
- Real-time spend visibility across teams with per-team usage controls
- No platform markup — tokens billed at cost; the gateway itself is free

Business model: Free for the gateway; premium tiers for larger enterprise support. Revenue likely comes from volume enterprise contracts and support tiers. This is a land-and-expand play targeting engineering teams first, then

scaling through organizational spend governance.

Market position: Competing in the LLM gateway category alongside LiteLLM, Portkey, and similar tools — but differentiating on enterprise-grade compliance posture (free by default, not bolted on) and managed infrastructure (no self-hosting required). Concentrated squarely on the transition from AI experimentation to production deployment.

Why this matters now: They launched publicly this month. Ari is in early go-to-market mode. This meeting is likely part of a broader outreach to enterprise technology partners, advisors, or potential customers.

3. Improving's Position

Improving is a **\$300M modern digital services firm** with practices spanning AI, Data Engineering, Application Development, and Platform Engineering. David leads One Texas, the regional initiative covering the Texas market.

Why this meeting matters for Improving:

Concentrate AI is building the infrastructure layer that enterprises need to govern, scale, and control AI usage in production. This sits directly in front of the implementation and integration work that Improving delivers. The opportunity is not to compete — it's to position Improving as the services layer that makes Concentrate's product actually land inside enterprise clients.

Three angles worth pursuing:

1. **Channel / co-sell partner.** Improving's enterprise client base (mid-market and large enterprise across Texas and beyond) are exactly the accounts that need an LLM gateway before they can responsibly scale AI workloads. Concentrate gets a distribution channel; Improving gets a differentiating infrastructure capability to bring into accounts.
2. **Implementation arm.** When Concentrate sells into an enterprise, someone has to wire it into their existing identity stack (Entra ID, Azure, SSO), integrate with existing data pipelines, and configure team-level access controls. That's Improving's wheelhouse — Platform Engineering and AI practice in tandem.
3. **One Texas insertion point.** Improving's AI narrative in the Texas market needs concrete infrastructure partners to anchor its positioning. Concentrate AI gives David a well-funded, freshly launched product to reference in prospect conversations around AI governance — a topic every enterprise buyer is wrestling with right now.

What Improving brings that Concentrate cannot replicate internally:

- Enterprise relationships across industries in Texas and nationally
- Delivery capacity: architects, engineers, project leads ready to implement
- Existing trust with IT buyers who need a services partner alongside a SaaS tool
- Data and AI practice credibility to speak the language of both the CISO and the CTO

Framing for the call: Improve comes in not as a customer evaluating the product, but as a potential strategic partner — someone who can help Concentrate reach enterprise buyers faster and ensure those buyers successfully adopt the platform.

4. Proposed Agenda

30 minutes. David controls the pace.

Time	Block	Purpose
0:00–2:00	Open / reconnect	Brief personal catch-up; acknowledge the launch
2:00–10:00	Ari demos Concentrate AI	Let Ari show the product — watch for the enterprise governance story
10:00–18:00	Discovery	Understand their go-to-market, ICP, and where services/partners fit
18:00–25:00	Improving's position	David shares the regional context and surfaces the partner angle
25:00–30:00	Identify the path forward	Establish whether this is a referral relationship, co-sell, or something else

5. Talking Points

Opening — acknowledge the moment

Concentrate launched publicly this month with \$5M behind it and True Ventures on the cap table. That's a real signal. Lead with genuine recognition of the launch and ask Ari how the first weeks have felt.

During the demo — listen for the enterprise friction points

Ari's product solves a real problem: enterprises are running AI experiments in silos, burning token budget without visibility, and accumulating compliance risk they don't know they have. As he demos, listen for the specific objections he hears most — that tells you which enterprise buyers are closest to buying and what they're afraid of.

The services angle — frame it as what makes Concentrate actually stick

"We see the same problem from the other side. Our clients are building AI capabilities, and the governance and infrastructure layer is always the hard part — not the model choice. What you're building solves the exact problem our delivery teams run into when we try to scale AI inside enterprise accounts."

One Texas context

"I run the Texas region for Improving. We have active relationships with enterprise accounts across Dallas, Houston, Austin — exactly the kind of mid-market and large enterprise companies that are in the AI experimentation-to-production transition right now. That's your ICP."

The partnership question — ask it directly

"Where does services fit in your go-to-market? Do you have an implementation or channel partner motion, or is that something you're still figuring out?" This surfaces whether there's a formal path or whether David needs to propose one.

If they're pre-partner-program

"We'd be interested in being an early partner — we can bring you into conversations where the governance problem is live. In return, when Concentrate is in an account, we'd want to be the implementation option you point to." Clean,

reciprocal, low-friction to agree to.

Ari's pattern — serial exits through enterprise distribution

Circulate was acquired by LiveRamp largely because of its ability to plug into enterprise identity infrastructure.

Concentrate has the same DNA. Ari understands that enterprise distribution is the real moat — he will respond to a conversation about how Improving accelerates his enterprise reach.

Watch the clock at 25 minutes

Reserve 5 minutes for a clear "what's next." Don't let the meeting end without a named next step — whether that's Ari connecting David with their partnerships lead, a follow-up call with the technical co-founder, or a specific account introduction.